

Varronia rupicola

no common name – a shrub

Family (Cordiaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Threatened)

Description

A woody shrub that can grow up to 5 meters tall, either as a single stem or with multiple branches. It is federally listed as a threatened species and occurs in a few isolated populations in Puerto Rico and the British Virgin Islands. In Puerto Rico, it is mainly found in the Guánica Commonwealth Forest and nearby areas.



Location/Habitat



Distributed along the southern coast of Puerto Rico, particularly in the municipalities of Ponce and Peñuelas, where it occurs in clusters on nearby hills. It is also found on Vieques Island (Puerto Ferro within the Vieques National Wildlife Refuge) and extends east to Anegada in the British Virgin Islands, where two populations are present.

Sources: <https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/species/6258>

https://ecos.fws.gov/docs/recovery_plan/20230602_Recovery%20Plan%20for%20Varronia%20rupicola.pdf